Snowden's name, so the government and public response would stay on the stories, not on the whistle-blower.

Greenwald's first story, published on June 5 in the *Guardian* newspaper, was about a secret NSA program that required the telecom company Verizon to release millions of telephone records. On June 6, the *Guardian*

LAURA POITRAS AND GLENN GREENWALD

The two people who would eventually help Snowden change the future of government became almost as famous as Snowden himself. Born in Boston, Massachusetts, in 1964, Laura Poitras moved to San Francisco, California, after high school. She worked as a chef and studied filmmaking at the San Francisco Art Institute. She moved to New York in 1992, where she began studying documentary filmmaking. Her first film as director was released in 2003. Her documentary *My Country, My Country*, was nominated for Best Documentary at the 2007 Academy Awards. Her documentary about Edward Snowden, *Citizenfour*, won the 2015 Academy Award for Best Documentary. She is based in Berlin, Germany.

Glenn Greenwald was born in Queens, New York, in 1967 and spent his childhood in South Florida. After graduating from George Washington University and New York University School of Law, he began his career as an attorney with an interest in defending civil liberties. In 2005, he quit his law practice and moved to Brazil, where he began writing a political blog.

In 2014, Greenwald and Poitras—along with investigative reporter Jeremy Scahill—founded an online magazine called the *Intercept*, which, according to its website, is "dedicated to producing fearless, adversarial journalism."[4]

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